

Each arm has two rotor blades.

Volocopter VC200

PASSENGER DRONES

Drones are small robotic craft that either fly by themselves or are remote-controlled. Multiple rotors allow a drone's position in the air to be controlled precisely. Most drones are tiny remote-controlled flying cameras that give a bird's-eye view of places too difficult or dangerous for people to go to. An experimental German craft, the electric-powered Volocopter is like a small flying car that can carry two people.

ELECTRIC AIR TAXI

Although just at the trial stage, the Lilium air taxi concept could be the way people get around in the future. It's a flying car powered by nonpolluting and silent electric jet engines (not powered by fossil fuels). The craft has 12 flaps that help engines provide lift. At take-off, the flaps are tilted vertically, and once the craft is in the air, they tilt horizontally to provide acceleration.

Depending on the flight mode, the flaps tilt from a vertical position to a horizontal position.

▼ LILIUM TAXI

This air taxi may carry up to five people.

Flaps can tilt horizontally or vertically.